

Moto Buds+

Sound by Bose with a twist

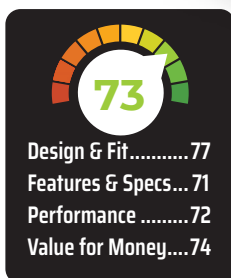
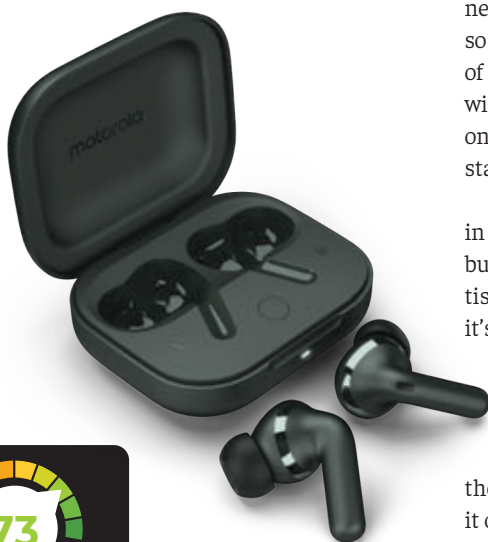
After a successful year in the smartphone industry, Motorola has ventured into the highly competitive TWS earphones market to bolster its ecosystem of products. The company has launched two new wireless earphones – the premium Moto Buds+ priced at ₹9,999 and the more affordable Moto Buds at ₹4,999. The Moto Buds+ are developed in collaboration with the legendary audio company Bose and proudly display the “Sound by Bose” tag. This move continues Motorola’s trend of strategic partnerships, having previously collaborated with Pantone on various phones, and now teaming up with Bose to stay ahead in the audio space. At this price point, the Moto Buds+ competes with top-tier TWS earbuds such as the OPPO Enco X2 and OnePlus Buds Pro 2. While this is not Motorola’s first foray into the audio market, it is undoubtedly their most deliberated effort. Can Motorola carve out a niche for itself in this fiercely competitive market? Let’s find out.

BUILD, DESIGN, AND FIT

Sporting a cobble-shaped charging case, the Moto Buds+’s design language is quite minimalist to the point of being uninspired. It lacks the distinctive “it-factor” needed to stand out in the competitive TWS market. However, the prominent “Sound by Bose” branding on the front of the case highlights Bose’s collaboration in creating the Moto Buds+, which adds a touch of prestige.

The earbuds are available in two simple colours – Forest Grey and Beach Sand. While neither is particularly eye-catching, the Beach Sand variant appears slightly more polished. The case is compact enough to fit easily in small

₹9,999



purses or pockets, and its matte texture feels good to the touch, though it is prone to scratching.

The earbuds themselves have a matte finish and are quite lightweight, weighing just 4 grams each. This makes them ideal for gym workouts or running, as they stay securely in place. They are also extremely comfortable, offering a snug fit that allows for hours of music listening with minimal discomfort.

In terms of durability, the case lacks a metal hinge, giving it a slightly flimsy feel for its ₹10K price point. However, the magnets inside are strong enough to keep the buds securely nestled even if the case is dropped. The earbuds have an IP54 rating, while the charging case has an IPX4 rating, meaning both are protected against splashes, but only the buds are resistant to dust damage.

In my opinion, the OnePlus Buds Pro 2 has a much more distinctive and premium design, so, if looks are important to you, consider buying the OnePlus Buds Pro 2 since they also have a fantastic fit.

FEATURES

The Moto Buds+ is brimming with premium features. The earbuds come with Adaptive Active Noise Cancellation, wireless charging, a highly customisable Moto Buds app, Dolby Atmos and Dolby Head Tracking, multipoint connectivity, Voice Assistant support, and so much more. The Moto Buds+ is one of the most feature-laden pairs of truly wireless earbuds you can get your hands on under ₹10,000. Let’s go through the standout features one at a time.

Bose hasn’t just assisted Motorola in the sound tuning of the Moto Buds+, but also ANC. Leveraging Bose’s expertise in manufacturing ANC earphones, it’s a tad surprising that the ANC on

the Moto Buds+ does not quite meet expectations. Of course, it doesn’t compete with ultra-flagships such as the Sony WF-1000XM5 and the QuietComfort Ultra Earbuds, but it offers inadequate noise suppression, even for its price, particularly in the mids and the highs. So sadly, if you’re in traffic or amidst a lot of human chatter, the noise cancellation is quite weak.

The earbuds also come with Adaptive ANC that intelligently identifies ambient noise and automatically switches between ANC levels to the most appropriate one. The Transparency Mode, while decent, does sound slightly unnatural though.

One of the best features of the Moto Buds+ is its excellent companion app. The Moto Buds app has an array of customisation options ranging from a robust 10-band EQ to gesture customisation. The level of customisation you can get over the sound and controls is quite impressive. Additionally, the app also allows users to check battery percentage, switch between noise cancellation modes, toggle dual connection and low latency mode, and perform firmware updates.

PERFORMANCE

Motorola has worked in close cooperation with Bose to tune the sound of the Moto Buds+. The buds are equipped with a 11mm bass driver and a 6mm